Essential Volunteer Management Practices
Assessment

Please indicate the degree to which these practices are part of the Host Site's routine program operation.

Rating Scale: 0 = Never 1 = Sometimes 2 = Always

Name: Ava Birdwell, Briar Williams **Host Site:** Hurricane Island Center for Science and Leadership	***Initial Assessment*** Date: Click to enter date.	***Final Assessment*** Date: Click to enter date.
There is a written policy or statement on volunteer involvement	1 = Sometimes	1 = Sometimes
Volunteer involvement is linked to organizational or program outcomes or strategic plan	0 = Never	1 = Sometimes
New paid staff are oriented about why and how volunteers are involved in the organization's work	2 = Always	2 = Always
Designated manager/leader for overseeing management of volunteers agency-wide	1 = Sometimes	1 = Sometimes
There is a periodic needs assessment to determine how volunteers should be involved in agency activities	0 = Never	1 = Sometimes
There are written role descriptions for each type of volunteer assignment	0 = Never	1 = Sometimes
There are written policies and procedures for operation of the volunteer program and the involvement of volunteers	0 = Never	2 = Always
The organizational budget shows expenses for the volunteer program	0 = Never	0 = Never
Periodically, the risks associated with volunteer assignments and involvement are assessed	1 = Sometimes	1 = Sometimes
Liability coverage extends to volunteers	2 = Always	2 = Always
There is a volunteer recruitment plan with specific strategies for outreach	0 = Never	1 = Sometimes
Standardized screening and matching procedures for determining appropriate placement of volunteers	1 = Sometimes	1 = Sometimes
Consistent general orientation for new volunteers	2 = Always	2 = Always
Consistent training for new volunteers regarding specific duties and responsibilities	2 = Always	2 = Always
There are designated supervisors for all volunteer roles	2 = Always	2 = Always
Periodic assessments of volunteer performance	0 = Never	0 = Never
Periodic assessments of staff support for volunteers	1 = Sometimes	1 = Sometimes
Consistent activities for recognizing volunteer contributions	1 = Sometimes	2 = Always
Consistent activities for recognizing staff support for volunteers	0 = Never	1 = Sometimes
There is a record-keeping system that regularly collects data (numerical and anecdotal) about volunteer involvement	2 = Always	2 = Always
Information about volunteer results and issues are shared with board members and other stakeholders at least twice annually	1 = Sometimes	1 = Sometimes
Volunteer manager is included in organizational planning	0 = Never	0 = Never

Essential Volunteer Management Practices
Assessment Summaries

Name: Briar and Ava **Host Site:** Hurricane Island Center for Science and Leadership

EVMP Initial Assessment Summary

After completing your initial EVMP assessment, please include a 300-word essay on:

1. What is the current state of your host sites' volunteer management practices?
2. Identify and describe three things on the EVMP Assessment that you plan to improve for your host site during your term.
3. How do you plan on improving these three things?

Initial EVMP Assessment Summary	Date: 5/7/2026
Hurricane Island Center for Science and Leadership has great volunteer management practices and welcomes volunteers throughout the season while also having 2 dedicated volunteer days, one in spring and one in the fall. We also noticed that Hurricane Island could have more written and standardized policies, procedures, and role descriptions for volunteers, as most information is only given verbally. Through this assessment we also gained a greater appreciation for the challenges of having volunteers on the island as well as the unique and extremely helpful role they play in supporting Hurricane Island's operations. During our service on Hurricane, we plan to establish written role descriptions for volunteers, implement activities and ways to recognize staff support for volunteers, and create a record-keeping system of volunteer involvement data. In order to establish written role descriptions for volunteers, we will communicate with each director/manager on the island (Education, Facilities, Galley, Boating, and Operations) to see what activities they have had volunteers do in the past, what they look forward to having volunteers do in the future, and what skills they might be looking for in volunteers. To improve the ways of recognizing both volunteers and staff support for volunteers, we may expand emailed and written thank you notes for volunteers and staff during the off season. Keeping volunteers involved and letting them see the positive impacts of their work is important for building lasting community and volunteer connections, especially in a place that is difficult to travel to. Finally, to create a record-keeping system of volunteer involvement data we will utilize MCC volunteer tracking sheets and create a designated spreadsheet for tracking anecdotal and quantitative data of volunteer involvement, as well as trying to put this data into Hurricane Island databases. We will also help Hurricane Island keep track of their volunteer activities and experiences throughout the season, not only at the 2 dedicated volunteer days.	

Host Site Supervisor Signature _____ Date: 5/13/26

Member Signature _____

Essential Volunteer Management Practices
Assessment Summaries



_____ Date: 5/13/26

EVMP Final Assessment Summary

After completing your final EVMP assessment, please include a 300-word essay on:

1. Compare your Initial and Final EVMP and explain how your host sites' volunteer management practices have improved during your term of service.
2. Describe what volunteer management skills you have gained throughout your term of service.

Final EVMP Assessment Summary	Date: 10/15/2026 Click to enter date.

In our initial EVMP, we planned to "establish written role descriptions for volunteers, implement activities and ways to recognize staff support for volunteers, and create a record-keeping system of volunteer involvement data." We also undertook the planning of a "Volunteer Week" separate from designated and pre-existing "Volunteer Days." During the planning and execution of "Friends and Family Volunteer Week" we strengthened our volunteer management skills such as recruitment, placing volunteers with their interests, passions and skills, and rewarding volunteers for their time, energy, and support. Regarding our initial EVMP assessment, we succeeded in establishing written role descriptions for volunteers based on where they are supporting (eg. The kitchen/galley, garden, and aquaculture team). First, we spoke with all managers on the island and inquired about how many volunteers they would like and what activities they would typically do. Using this information, we included descriptions in the survey that we sent out to participants, both to let them know about volunteer activity options and begin to place volunteers with their interests and skills for day-of service. This survey can be reused in the future for scheduling and creating more volunteer weeks and days. In relation to recognizing staff support for volunteers as well as recognizing and rewarding volunteers, we did this both informally and formally. We were sure to thank staff for their involvement with volunteers and their help with planning logistics. We also implemented hand-written notes for volunteers that were delivered to them the week after our "Volunteer Week." This included thanking them for the specific tasks they did, encouraging them to come out to the island and/or volunteer again, and many staff members' signatures. During our service, we recorded all volunteers that came to the island and the hours that they served with the help of MCC volunteer sheets. It proved to be slightly more difficult than initially expected aligning all volunteer data (qualitative and quantitative) into a single

spreadsheet / database because most volunteers register with CampBrain (a software that Hurricane Island uses). However, we communicated with the Program Manager to try and begin implementing a simple Google Sheet to try and make the information more accessible and compiled. Overall, we are proud of implementing volunteer management skills and expanding connections with our host site.

Host Site Supervisor Signature ____

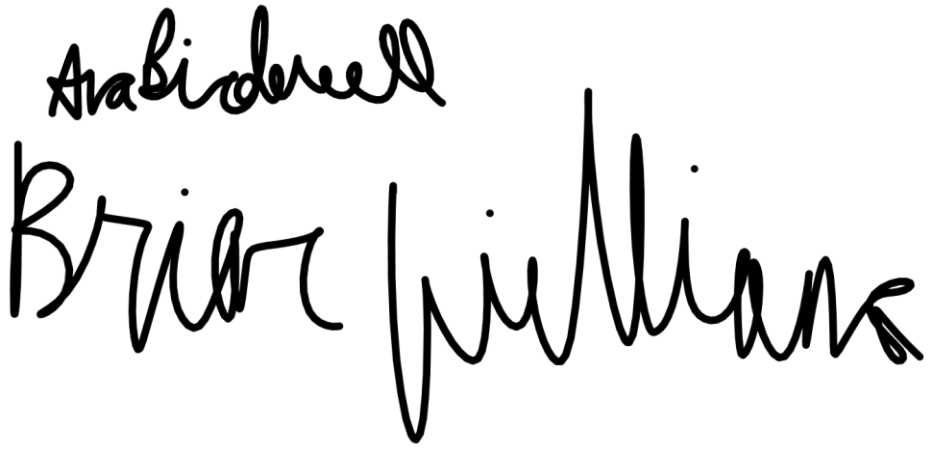


_____

Essential Volunteer Management Practices
Assessment Summaries

Date: 10/15/2026

Member Signature _____



_____

Date: 10/15/2026